In Praise of the Holy Guru, the Dharma King

Paramanagurudharmārājastotranāma · Toh 1172 · Derge Tengyur
བླ་མ་དམ་པ་ཆོས་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ་ལ་བསྟོད་པ

In Praise of the Holy Guru, the Dharma King, whose Sanskrit title is given as Paramanagurudharmārājastotra and whose Tibetan title is Lama Dampa Chökyi Gyalpo la Töpa, is a short hymn of four ornate verses composed by the Indian paṇḍita and great poet Lakṣmīkara, who translated it into Tibetan together with the translator Shongtön at the temple of glorious Sakya. The master it celebrates is not named, but the praise of him as the one who calmed the ocean-like hosts of the Mongols with a mere glance, together with the Sakya setting, points to the Sakya hierarch Chögyal Phakpa, who served as preceptor at the Mongol court in the thirteenth century. The poem hails him as a sun of the Dharma that rose on the mountains of Tibet and spread its light to the lands of the east, as one who makes the bull of the Dharma walk the earth as in the golden age even in a degenerate time, and as one whose unfeigned compassion reaches all beings just as the earth, the sun, the clouds, the wind, the moon and space serve the world. Three of its four verses close with the refrain "may that Dharma King be victorious." It is Toh 1172 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of praises (stotra), and it is notable as a hymn by an Indian scholar addressed to a Tibetan master.

In the language of India: paramanagurudharmārājastotranāma
In the language of Tibet: In Praise of the Holy Guru, the Dharma King.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

With towering rows of waves, its vast hosts of horsemen, and with lassos, swords and sharp spears
For its countless terrifying sea creatures, roaring with great drums, this whole ocean at the end of time known as the Mongols
The all-learned guru, by the play of his sidelong glance, for the peace of the worlds,
Brought to rest in the supreme way of the Victor: may that Dharma King be victorious!

He who attained a most stainless rising on the mountains of Tibet in the west, and step by step
Subdued the lands of the eastern quarters, destroying the immense darkness born of delusion,

And so that beings may reach the city of awakening, with the net of rays of his Dharma speech, just like the Buddha,
Gives brilliant light: may that Dharma King, wreathed in supreme rays, be victorious!

To benefit all beings from the Dvāpara age onward, the supreme bull of the Victor, which depends on beings,
The bull that in the Kṛta age trod on four legs, and in the Tretā on three,
That in the Dvāpara moves on a pair of legs, and in the Kali has a single leg remaining,
He ever makes walk upon the earth as in the Kṛta age: may that Dharma King be victorious!

Just as, in the worlds, the earth upholds living creatures, and the sun too
Fills the world with light, the clouds send down rain, and the wind stirs,
The moon pours forth streams of nectar, and space is magnanimous in granting room,
So the Dharma King extends his unfeigned compassion fully to all sentient beings.

This is the Praise of the Holy Guru, the Dharma King, composed by the Indian paṇḍita, the great poet Lakṣmīkara. It was translated at the temple of glorious Sakya by that same paṇḍita and the translator Shongtön.

Translator's Notes

- The Dharma King praised here is not named; the taming of the Mongols, the setting at Sakya and the translator Shongtön point to Chögyal Phakpa of Sakya (1235 to 1280). The third verse draws on the Indian image of the Dharma as a bull that stands on four legs in the Kṛta age and loses one leg in each of the three later ages. The opening words of that verse, gnyis ldan tshu, are obscure, and the line has a syllable too many; the translation reads the stray syllable tshu as tshun, "from ... onward".

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of

spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.